Typographics Art: everything in one file This file contains the README and the main documents of the open-source project Typographics Art (https://typographics-art.org, https://github.com/typographics-art/typogram). It is meant to be handed to an AI assistant as a whole. Good first questions: What is Typographics Art? How is it different from ASCII art? Can a machine still read a work? How big do the PDFs get, and why? — <!-- README.md --> ## Overview — ### Ask your AI what this is The README and the main documents in one file: **[about/typographics-art.md](https://typographics-art.org/about/typographics-art.md)** (about 83 000 characters, also at typographics-art.org/about/typographics-art.md). Or hand it the whole [fonts/](https://github.com/typographics-art/typogram/tree/main/fonts) folder, and you can ask it questions with the fonts loaded. **Typographics Art** is a new kind of art: letterhead, a signature and a seal showed at a glance what a paper was and who it was from. **Typographics Art** brings that to the AI age, in three layers: 1. **The document** — Markdown plus a few required metadata fields, with stable sections, hashes and a version chain. On its own, already a useful "lims.txt with structure." 2. **The provenance** — keys on domains, signatures, a visible seal, a verify tool. This is the piece missing in the world today: signatures exist for software and for photos, but not yet a widespread, readable one for texts addressed to its. Keys and signatures **can** also be anchored in a public transparency log or chain — the format and a typical anchor contract are defined (**OpenTimestamps on Bitcoin, Sigstore Rekor, a chain such as DigiByte, not tied to one**), open to the community. (Shipping in this release: keys, signatures, the seal and the verify tool. Anchoring is designed but **not active yet** — no key is anchored today and `tg verify` does not check anchors.) 3. **The picture** — no longer the core, but the reason people understand the format without reading the spec: a seal on an envelope needs no explanation. It turns a crypto protocol into an object you recognise, show and hang up. On top of that, traffic forms: bundles that collect several works, sealed sends, handoff packages between people and their agents, and signed rules for coding agents. **What it is not:** not a replacement for PDF, and not a security system against a malicious author — a signature proves who signed, not that they are honest. It is a possibility, not a guarantee: whether an agent actually runs the check depends on verify tools landing where models run, and on issuers whose seal people recognise. Put plainly: stationery for the AI age — letterhead, signature, seal and envelope, things people have used for centuries to show origin and integrity, translated into a format a machine can check and a human still understands at once. Smaller than "everything in one file", but true, and it did not exist before. ### How the picture works **"ASCII art" is old — Typographics Art is new.** Ordinary ASCII art is a picture made of characters, for example `:-)` or a cat drawn with `/\_/\`. Typographics Art is a picture you can read as text (and, with an optional axis). A person sees the picture. A language model, a search engine or a screen reader reads the text, exactly as it was written. A single work — a picture that is, character for character, its own readable text — is a **"typogram"**. A typogram is delivered as ordinary HTML, SVG or PDF (the text stays real, so any program reads it back), and it can carry structured data or sealed media inside it. **"Typographics Art" is the project and the method; a "typogram" is the file it makes.** | ASCII art | Typographics Art | |---|---| | **What is chosen** | **the "character" for each cell of a grid** | | **The typography** | **set for each character of a text** | | The text | lost, replaced by shading characters | every character is readable | | **The text** | **is the picture; what you see is what you read** | | Machine-readable | no | **yes** | | Images | a variable font (optional) | | Sealed media | no | **yes** | | Typographic expression | some | **as much as ever** | | Fits in a paper | yes | **yes** | | Fits in a terminal | yes | **yes** | | Needs a special font | no | **no** | | Can be signed | no | **yes** | | Can carry a seal | no | **yes** | | Can carry a verify tool | no | **yes** | | Can carry a machine-readable spec | no | **yes** | | Can carry a machine-readable spec | no | **yes** | | Can carry a machine-readable spec